

“Man will not get anything unless he works hard” (Surah al-Najm, 53:39).

ENG502 FINAL TERM MCQS 2023-2024

COMPILED BY SIR ZAHID

Join Our WhatsApp Group  VU-All-(Bs English Group)

Click  [\(JOIN NOW\)](#)

1. De Saussure explained that the relationship between the signifier and _____ is an arbitrary one.

- A. Signification
- B. Signified**
- C. Signify
- D. Sign

Explanation: Saussure's theory of the linguistic sign defines the relationship between signifier (sound/image) and signified (concept) as arbitrary, meaning there is no natural connection between them.

2. In syntax, the most common way to create a visual representation of syntactic structure is _____ diagram.

- A. Syntactic
- B. Object
- C. Class
- D. Tree**

Explanation: Tree diagrams are widely used in syntax to show the hierarchical and phrase structure of sentences.

3. The grammar must be capable of showing how a single underlying abstract representation can become different _____ structures.

- A. Cavernous
- B. Both deep and surface structure

C. Deep

D. Surface

Explanation: Surface structure represents the actual sentence form derived from the deep (abstract) structure using transformational rules.

4. Deep and surface structures are often used as terms in a simple _____ opposition.

A. Binary

B. Fraction

C. Lone

D. Exponential

Explanation: Chomsky introduced deep vs. surface structure as a binary contrast in transformational-generative grammar.

5. Phrases can also be structurally _____.

A. Ambiguous

B. None of the given options

C. Definite

D. Unambiguous

Explanation: Structural ambiguity arises when a phrase or sentence can be interpreted in more than one way due to its structure.

6. The word 'syntax' literally means 'putting together' or _____.

A. Chaos

B. Commotion

C. Arrangement

D. Derangement

Explanation: "Syntax" comes from the Greek word syntaxis, meaning 'putting together' or 'arrangement'.

7. In the sentence 'Mary put out the fire', particle movement is _____.

A. Essential

B. Obligatory

C. Optional

D. Mandatory

Explanation: Particle movement (e.g., "put out the fire" vs. "put the fire out") is optional in English syntax.

8. The symbol “()” used in syntactic description of a sentence indicates _____ elements in a sentence.

A. Compulsory

B. None of the given options

C. Neutral

D. Optional

Explanation: Parentheses in syntax show that the enclosed elements are optional.

9. In grammar, the nouns such as Mary and George are _____ nouns.

A. Proper

B. Common

C. Concrete

D. Abstract

Explanation: Names like Mary and George are proper nouns as they refer to specific individuals.

10. In linguistics, _____ feature may indicate the attitude or mental state of the speaker.

A. Bilingual

B. Communicative

C. Monolingual

D. Paralinguistic

Explanation: Paralinguistic features (tone, intonation, facial expression) convey emotions and attitudes beyond words.

11. In grammar, a phrase or a clause that violates some grammar rule of a particular language is called a/an _____ phrase or clause.

A. Well-structured

B. Ill-formed

C. Well-formed

D. Uniformed

Explanation: A phrase or clause that does not conform to grammatical rules is called ill-formed.

12. A sentence has a noun phrase and a _____ phrase.

A. Adverb

B. Prepositional

C. Verb

D. Pronoun

Explanation: A typical English sentence consists of a noun phrase (NP) and a verb phrase (VP).

13. In Syntax, connotative meaning is also called _____ meaning.

A. Descriptive

B. Associative

C. Denotative

D. Explanatory

Explanation: Connotative meaning is also known as associative meaning, reflecting personal or emotional associations.

14. He drew the picture with a crayon. Semantically, in this sentence a crayon is a/an _____.

A. None of the given options

B. Goal

C. Agent

D. Instrument

Explanation: In semantic roles, an instrument is the entity used to perform an action. Here, crayon is the instrument.

15. The horse is reading the newspaper. This sentence is an example of _____.

- A. Syntactic oddness
- B. Pragmatic oddness
- C. Discourse oddness

D. Semantic oddness

Explanation: The sentence is grammatically correct but semantically odd, since horses can't read.

16. "We transfer money from savings to checking." Semantically, in this sentence the goal is _____.

- A. From checking
- B. None of the given options

C. To checking

D. Transfer money

Explanation: In semantics, goal is the endpoint of an action. "To checking" is the destination (goal) of the transfer.

17. In Semantics, the study of the tune and rhythm of speech is called _____.

- A. Poesy
- B. Parody
- C. Prosody**
- D. Poetry

Explanation: Prosody refers to features like intonation, stress, and rhythm in speech that affect meaning.

18. An agent is usually the grammatical _____ of the verb in an active clause.

- A. Complement
- B. Subject**
- C. Object
- D. Preposition

Explanation: In semantic roles, the agent is typically the subject doing the action in an active voice sentence.

19. In semantic roles, the entity that is moved by the action or event denoted by the predicate is an example of _____.

A. Agent

B. Theme

C. Source

D. Experience

Explanation: The theme is the entity that undergoes or is affected by the action.

20. Curly brackets in syntactic analysis indicate that only _____ of the elements enclosed within the curly brackets must be selected.

A. Two

B. One

C. Four

D. Three

Explanation: Curly brackets indicate alternatives—only one of the enclosed elements should be selected.

21. The sentence 'John believed that Cathy knew that Mary helped George.' is tediously _____.

A. Difficult

B. Large

C. Tough

D. Recursive

Explanation: The sentence is an example of recursion, where clauses are embedded within one another.

22. In syntax, IC analysis stands for _____ analysis.

A. Immediate Constituent

B. Intelligence Community

C. Integrated Constituent

D. Inner Circle

Explanation: Immediate Constituent (IC) analysis breaks down a sentence into its major components.

23. In English, a _____ phrase consists of a preposition and a noun phrase.

A. Prepositional

B. Noun

C. Verb

D. Adverbial

Explanation: A prepositional phrase = preposition + noun phrase (e.g., "on the table").

24. The entity that is involved in or affected by the action called the theme or sometimes the _____.

A. Source

B. Goal

C. Patient

D. Instrument

Explanation: In some frameworks, theme is also referred to as patient, especially in biomedical/linguistic models.

25. One of the properties of generative grammar is that grammar has _____ number of rules but is capable of producing _____ number of sentences.

A. Finite, Infinite

B. Infinite, Finite

C. Infinite, Restricted

D. Finite, Limited

Explanation: Chomsky's generative grammar has a finite set of rules but can generate infinite sentences.

26. The deep structure is a/an _____ level of structural organization in which all the elements determining structural interpretation are represented.

A. Abstract

- B. Concrete
- C. Numerical
- D. All of the given options

Explanation: Deep structure is an abstract syntactic representation reflecting meaning.

27. The rules that relate the spoken form of sentence to their underlying meaning are called _____ rules.

- A. Recursive
- B. Phrase structure
- C. Transformational**
- D. Sentence structure

Explanation: Transformational rules convert deep structure into surface structure.

28. In semantics, _____ meaning is the type of meaning that comes from the context within which the sentence is used.

- A. Evocative
- B. Descriptive
- C. Propositional**
- D. Factual

Explanation: Propositional meaning involves the truth-value and context of the sentence.

29. The set of possible expressions in a given language may or may not be infinite, the actual set of all expressions ever uttered is going to be _____.

- A. Expressions
- B. Finite**
- C. Infinite
- D. All of the given options

Explanation: Although potential sentences are infinite, the actual utterances are always finite.

30. In Semantics, the associative or _____ meaning of an expression has to do with individual mental understandings of the speaker.

- A. Lexical
- B. Literal
- C. Connotative**
- D. Narrative

Explanation: Connotative (associative) meaning reflects subjective or emotional interpretations.

31. One fact seems to be important in the child's acquisition process is the actual use of sound and word _____.

- A. Combination**
- B. Composition
- C. Affiliation
- D. Dissolution

Explanation: Children use sound and word combinations in their acquisition process as they learn syntax.

32. The standard way of demonstrating the genetic relatedness of languages is by means of _____ method.

- A. Comparative**
- B. Descriptive
- C. Linear
- D. Circular

Explanation: The comparative method is used in historical linguistics to show genetic relatedness.

33. The study of the history and origin of words is termed as _____.

- A. Semantics
- B. Dialectology
- C. Morphology
- D. Etymology**

Explanation: Etymology is the study of the origin and historical development of words.

34. As language is a mirror of mind, a computational understanding of language also provides insight into thinking and _____.

A. Intelligence

B. Behaviour

C. Absurdity

D. Immaturity

Explanation: Computational linguistics helps in understanding language and human intelligence.

35. According to Grimm's law, the letter 'p' of Latin has been changed into 'f' in _____.

A. Polish

B. Italian

C. Celtic

D. English

Explanation: Grimm's Law explains sound shifts such as Latin p → English f (e.g., pater → father).

36. Joseph Conrad said that there are individuals who can achieve great expertise in the _____ skill, but not the spoken language.

A. Writing

B. Reading

C. None of the above given options

D. Listening

Explanation: Conrad noted that some people excel at writing in a second language but not necessarily speaking it.

37. Which of the following languages was called "more perfect than the Greek and more copious than Latin" by Sir William Jones in Indian Law?

A. Hindi

B. Spanish

C. Irish

D. Sanskrit

Explanation: Sir William Jones praised Sanskrit for its structure and richness.

38. One-word stage (better one morpheme or one unit) or _____ stage starts between 9–18 months.

- A. Babbling
- B. Multiword
- C. Telegraphic

D. Holophrastic

Explanation: The holophrastic stage is where a child uses single words that represent whole ideas.

39. By the age of _____ the child's vocabulary expands rapidly.

- A. One
- B. All of the above given options
- C. One-and-a-half

D. Two-and-a-half

Explanation: Rapid vocabulary growth typically occurs by age two to two-and-a-half.

40. In forming questions, the child's first stage has almost _____ procedures.

- A. Five
- B. One
- C. Three
- D. Two

Explanation: In the first stage, children often use single word rising intonation to form questions.

41. The task of an automatic _____ analyzer is to take a word in a language and break it down into its stem.

- A. Morphological
- B. Phonetic

- C. Linguistic
- D. Grammatical

Explanation: A morphological analyzer breaks words into stems and morphemes.

42. Emotional reaction, or "affect," may also be caused as a language acquisition barrier due to _____.

- A. All of the given options**
- B. Unpleasant classroom surroundings
- C. Dull textbooks
- D. Exhausting schedule of study and/or work

Explanation: Affective factors include negative emotions from environment, materials, or fatigue.

43. Some children grow up in a social environment where more than one language is used and are able to acquire _____ language.

- A. None of the given options
- B. Mother language
- C. Second language
- D. First language**

Explanation: Children exposed to multiple languages simultaneously can acquire both as first languages.

44. With the wide use of email and cellular phones, _____ applications have started to become a presence in flight information and hotel reservation systems.

- A. Writing enabled
- B. All of the given options
- C. Sound enabled
- D. Speech enabled**

Explanation: Speech-enabled systems are increasingly used in service industries.

45. In the formation of questions and the use of negatives, there appear to be _____ identifiable stages.

- A. One
- B. Seven
- C. Five
- D. Three**

Explanation: There are three stages in the formation of questions and negatives in child language.

46. Vocabulary lists and sets of grammar rules are used to define the target of learning in _____.

- A. Communicative approach
- B. Silent approach
- C. Grammar translation method**
- D. Direct method

Explanation: The grammar-translation method focuses on vocabulary memorization and grammar rules.

47. The most fundamental change in the area of L2 is a shift teacher centered approach to _____ centered approach.

- A. Multimedia
- B. Note taking
- C. Textbook
- D. Learner**

Explanation: L2 teaching has shifted from teacher-led to learner-centered approaches.

48. According to researchers, the child's vocabulary moves beyond approximately fifty words in _____.

- A. Two word stage
- B. Multiword stage
- C. Four word stage
- D. One word stage

Explanation: In the two-word stage, vocabulary typically exceeds 50 words.

49. According to researchers by age three children from privileged families have heard _____ million more words than children from underprivileged families.

- A. 60
- B. 50
- C. 70
- D. 30**

Explanation: Studies show a 30 million word gap between children of different socioeconomic backgrounds by age 3.

50. Due to the shortcomings of the tree model, _____ model has recently gained more popularity among linguists.

- A. Interactive
- B. Constructionist
- C. Linear
- D. Wave**

Explanation: The wave model accounts for overlapping and diffusion of linguistic features better than the tree model.

51. In case of forming negatives expressions stage _____ seems to involve a simple strategy of putting NO or Not at the beginning.

- A. Two
- B. Three
- C. One**
- D. Fifth

Explanation: In the first stage of negation, children place "no" or "not" at the beginning of sentences.

52. According to researchers, in developing morphology, the acquisition of the plural marker is often accompanied by a process of _____ in a child.

- A. Over collateralization
- B. Oversimplification
- C. Over communication
- D. Overgeneralization**

Explanation: Children overgeneralize morphological rules (e.g., foots instead of feet).

53. Language change is variation over time in language's _____ morphological, semantic and syntactic features.

A. Phonological

B. Creative

C. Narrative

D. Descriptive

Explanation: Language change affects phonological, morphological, semantic, and syntactic levels.

54. Which of the following can be called 'A dream of science fiction'?

A. Discourse studies

B. Computational linguistics

C. Applied linguistics

D. Translation studies

Explanation: Computational linguistics was once viewed as science fiction but is now a reality.

55. Parents retell about their child's early speech usually involve examples of the _____ use of words.

A. Clear

B. Strange

C. Complex

D. Vibrant

Explanation: Early child language is often strange or unconventional, which parents find amusing or memorable.

56. The earliest use of speech-like sounds has been described as _____.

A. Babbling

B. Signaling

C. Cooing

D. Beckoning

Explanation: Cooing is the first stage of speech-like sounds in infants (typically around 6–8 weeks).

